

Olivia Koeppen

Canvas specialist and former English teacher who partners with college faculty to build clear, accessible, student-centered online courses, from first consultation to launch.

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My path

From the classroom to course design

2021–2023

English teacher, Capital High School

Taught English to 130+ students in Boise. I designed standards-aligned units, wrote assessments, and used student data to adapt lessons for very different learners.

I learned what makes students tune out, and what makes them lean in.

2023–2024

Technical Records Specialist, Boise State School of Nursing

Built and maintained Canvas course sites for undergraduate and graduate nursing programs, wrote the process documentation and training materials, and trained faculty and TAs on the tools.

I learned how college courses are built, and how to support busy faculty.

2024–now

Instructional Technologist II, Boise State School of Nursing

Now I consult with nursing faculty on online and hybrid courses from planning through launch. I run one-on-one and group trainings, build the tutorials and templates faculty use, and coordinate multi-course projects with accessibility (ADA/508, WCAG) built in.

I learned how to turn a faculty member's expertise into a course students can actually navigate.

Next

Instructional designer

I want to shape the learning itself, not just build it. The projects below show that side of my work..

Education: M.Ed. in Educational Leadership and B.A. in English, Secondary Education, Boise State University

Projects

Selected work

Launching every nursing course, every semester

Complete

Course Readiness for the School of Nursing

Context. The Boise State School of Nursing offers over 100 courses each term across its undergraduate and graduate programs. Each course needs a working Canvas site before the first day of classes, and I am the only staff member responsible for preparing them.

Problem. Course preparation had depended on individual requests arriving on time and being handled one at a time. With a program this size, that approach left room for inconsistency between courses and for last-minute gaps.

Approach. I developed program specific course standards and a pre-term readiness checklist covering course structure, settings, and required program content.

Outcome. Course sites were ready by the start of term, and faculty requests became more predictable.

Reflection. Consistency across courses matters for students who move through a program together. A predictable course layout lets them spend their attention on the content rather than on finding it.

Launch Checklist (Sample) [See attachment I emailed to you! :\)](#)

Accessibility in Nursing Canvas Courses

Context. Students in the School of Nursing use Canvas for readings, lectures, clinical materials, and exams. Course content has to be usable by every student, including those who rely on screen readers, captions, or keyboard navigation. Public universities are also required to meet federal accessibility standards.

Problem. Many course sites had been built over several years by different faculty. Common issues included missing alt text on images, videos without accurate captions, scanned PDFs that screen readers could not read, and low contrast color usage.

Approach. Working with stakeholders, I developed a process to review Canvas accessibility with faculty members, utilizing Ally, TidyUp and the Accessibility Report. I corrected issues within the course structure and worked with faculty to locate accessible materials. I added accessibility checks to the pre-term readiness checklist so new issues would be caught before course launch.

Outcome. Overall, 74% → 92% average accessibility scores across 100+ School of Nursing courses after remediation.

Reflection. Accessible design benefits more students than those with a documented need. Clear headings, captions, and readable documents help a student reviewing on a phone between clinical shifts as much as one using assistive technology.

[Accessibility Process Flow](#)

BS-DNP Online Course Template Redesign

Context. The Boise State School of Nursing's online BS-DNP program needed a new course template. I partnered with eCampus and the program director on the redesign, which has run for over a year.

Problem. The program's existing courses had been built at different times, so they varied in layout and structure. A new template only helps if current courses move into it without losing content or disrupting faculty, and new courses have to be built in it from the start.

Approach. I worked with eCampus and the program director to shape the new template and align it with program needs. I then migrated existing course content into the template alongside faculty, so the subject experts stayed in control of their material. I also worked with instructors to develop new courses in the template from the beginning.

Outcome. Seventeen existing courses have been migrated into the new template and ten courses completely from scratch have been built. The last two new courses launch Spring 2027.

Reflection. Students in a program move through many courses in sequence, and a shared template means they learn the layout once. It also gave faculty a shared starting point instead of a blank course so their time goes into teaching content.

[BS-DNP Template Course Redesign Examples](#)

Standardizing AI Use Expectations in the School of Nursing

Context. Generative AI is changing how students learn and how faculty think about assessment. Boise State has left AI rules to individual instructors, so expectations in the School of Nursing have depended on each course. As a member of the SON AI Task Force, I worked on a shared system for communicating AI use at the assignment level.

Problem. Students met different AI rules in every course, usually in a single syllabus paragraph. Faculty were reworking assignments for a new technology, and many had no simple way to explain what was allowed and why. A blanket statement did not fit assignments that call for very different levels of AI use, and rules without a rationale can push students toward the behavior they are meant to prevent.

Approach. The Task Force proposed that the School adopt the AI Assessment Scale (Perkins, Furze, Roe & MacVaugh, 2024), a five-level scale with consistent definitions, and that each assignment carry a matching icon and a short "why" explaining the choice. We recommended it over a three-level scale because the middle level leaves too much gray area and pushes faculty to write their own definitions. I created a shared library of standardized icons, embedded in each Canvas course, along with a one-page guide for adding them to assignments. I also built an HTML version of the scale for Canvas pages.

Outcome. Out of the ten first semester PreLicensure Nursing courses, six courses have currently adopted the icon system. We are currently looking into gathering student perception and impact.

Reflection. Clear expectations matter for students in any assignment, and AI is no exception. Faculty keep their academic freedom to set the level. What the system standardizes is how that level is communicated, so students can focus on the learning. Asking instructors to explain their reasoning also makes them think through what each assignment is meant to assess.

[AI Icon Faculty Guide \(PDF\)](#)

Skills

Design

- Online and hybrid course design
- Learning objectives and standards-aligned curriculum
- Assessments and rubrics

Build

- Canvas LMS
- Course templates and migration
- Multimedia integration
- Tutorials and faculty-facing training materials

Quality

- Accessibility (ADA/Section 508, WCAG)
- Accessibility review tools (Ally, TidyUp, Canvas Accessibility Report)
- Process documentation

Support

- One-on-one and group faculty consultation
- Workshops and training
- Multi-course project coordination
- Cross-team collaboration (OIT, eCampus, vendors)

Currently learning · [\[certifications and courses\]](#)